

■ Test Environment 01

FIRST WORLD OPERATOR

Minecraft Server Lead / First Player

“From the player’s perspective,
what kind of game intelligent agent
do we actually want?”

Macha is an open research project building a cognitive skeleton for game NPCs that is independent of any engine and any model. Minecraft is the first world we have connected it to. Minecraft is not the project.

STAGE	NPC CAPABILITY	COMPENSATION	LOCATION / HOURS
pre-implementation · Phase 0 → 1	not yet implemented	TBD	TBD

THE QUESTION

Why do intelligent NPCs still feel fake?

A model can give an NPC more knowledge than any hand-written dialogue tree. It can answer questions, hold a persona, and speak fluently. Players still walk away saying it felt like talking to a chatbot wearing a costume.

We are not asking how to make an NPC smarter. We are asking why more intelligence does not produce more presence.

THE USUAL QUESTION

how do we make the NPC smarter?

■ THE QUESTION WE ASK

why does more intelligence not produce presence?

A player starts treating an NPC as something that exists in the world at the moment they believe four things:

- 01 This NPC has its own state.**
It is doing something when I am not looking at it.
 - 02 This NPC has its own purpose.**
It wants something that is not me.
 - 03 This NPC remembers what happened.**
It carries the past forward instead of re-deriving it.
 - 04 This NPC is not generated to answer me.**
Its behaviour comes from being somewhere in the world.
-

None of these four are properties of intelligence. They are properties of a system that persists in a world over time. That is the gap this project exists to close — and it cannot be measured from inside the architecture.

- Which is why the person we are looking for is a player first, and a researcher second.

THE ROLE

First World Operator

This is not a Minecraft server administrator role.

■ NOT server admin · operations · GM · QA tester · community moderator

It is the intersection of four jobs that do not normally live in the same person.

SERVER LEAD	Keep the test world running, reachable, and in a known state.
FIRST PLAYER	Be the first real person inside it, for hours at a time.
WORLD OPERATOR	Shape the conditions the agents live in, and record what you changed.
NPC EXPERIENCE RESEARCHER	Find the moments that break the illusion, and explain why they break.

THE HONEST VERSION

Today the world runs, the boundary between Macha and the world is being specified, and the agent you would be testing has not been built. You would be the first person who is not building it to stand inside it and say what is wrong with it.

THIS IS A 0 → 1 ROLE

- You are not joining a finished product and executing a known procedure. Much of what defines this role does not exist yet, and you would be helping to write it:
- what makes an AI NPC good
 - what makes one read as fake
 - which parts of a world state an agent should be able to perceive
 - what behaviour actually counts as continuous
 - what relationship a player should be able to form with an NPC
- None of these have an accepted answer. That is the work.

WHAT YOU WILL DO

Five jobs. Only the third one is why the role exists.

01 RUN THE WORLD

Keep Test Environment 01 alive, reachable, and in a state you can describe. Not an operations role — you keep the place habitable so the experiment can run.

- server maintenance and world management
- basic configuration
- player access for testers
- a short record of what changed between sessions

02 BE THE FIRST PLAYER

Go in and live there, for hours rather than minutes. Talk to the agents, ignore them, help them, get in their way. Play, and keep asking one question:

- "if I do this, what happens?"

03 FIND THE FAKE

This is the job. You are not hunting for errors — you are hunting for the specific moments that make an agent read as fake:

- A bug report says "the NPC did X." Your report has to say why X made it feel like nothing was there.

LOOK FOR

- behaviour that does not fit the situation it is in
- memory a player can tell is not real
- a motive that does not hold up
- behaviour disconnected from the state of the world
- responses generated at the player rather than out of the world
- no continuity from one encounter to the next
- contradictions a person would not make
- something that sounds clever but is not an agent with a stake

04 CREATE SITUATIONS

Do not wait for behaviour to appear. Build the conditions that force it:

- change the agent's environment while it is not looking
- create conflict between two agents
- change what resources are available
- disappear for a long time, then come back
- give two agents a reason to know each other
- watch what happens when no player is present
- check how an agent reacts hours after an event, not seconds
- You are expected to propose your own experiments.

05 REPORT EXPERIENCE

Keep one Experience Log. One entry per moment that mattered:

SITUATION	OBSERVATION	PLAYER FEELING
WHY IT FELT WRONG	POSSIBLE CAUSE	NEXT EXPERIMENT

- No technical analysis is required. Write it the way you would describe it to another player. Player experience first — we handle the translation into engineering.

WHO WE ARE LOOKING FOR

Technical ability is not the first priority. It is not the second one either.

We would rather have a player who knows Minecraft deeply and knows nothing about AI, than an agent-framework expert who rarely plays. The first person will simply be better at this job.

WHAT WE WEIGHT

Minecraft experience



Sensitivity to NPC believability



Observation and articulation



Willingness to test over months



Server management



Java / Kotlin



AI / LLM



YOU MIGHT BE THIS PERSON IF

- you have played Minecraft for years and can still feel when something in the world is off
- you have opinions about how NPCs in games behave, and will defend them
- you notice small details other players walk past
- you have said “this feels wrong” about a game without yet being able to explain why
- you are willing to go back into the same world many times
- you are willing to write down what happened
- you want to propose your own experiments
- you can work without being managed closely

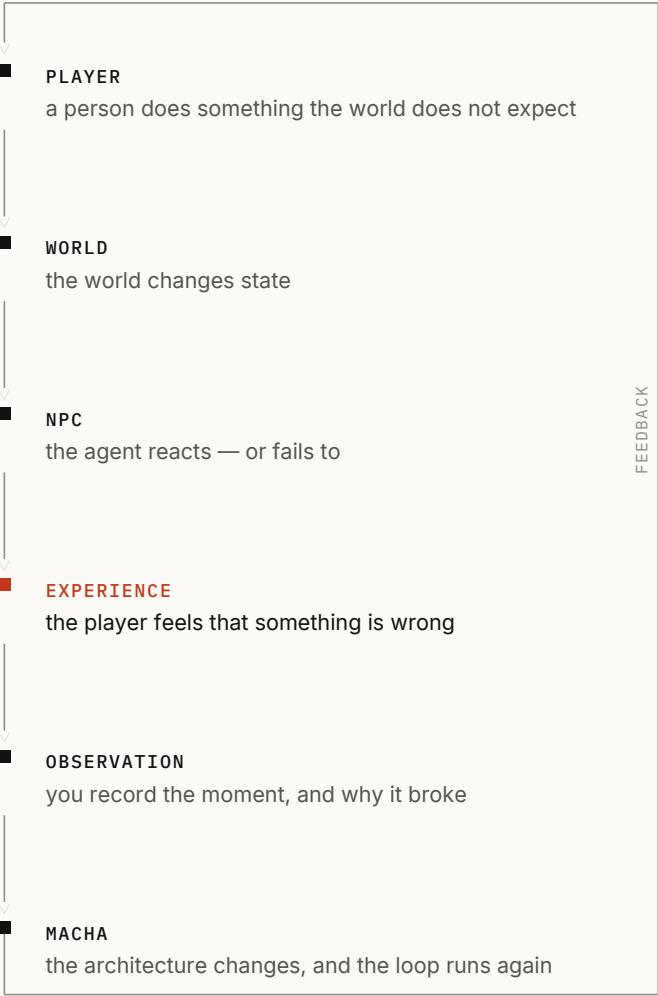
NOT FOR YOU IF

- you want a normal Minecraft admin position
- you want to maintain a server and be done
- you only want to test whether features run
- you are not interested in watching how agents behave
- you do not want to write anything down
- “why does an NPC read as real” is not a question you care about

THE EXPERIMENT

The role is one node in a feedback loop, and it is the node we cannot fill internally.

THE LOOP



EXPERIENCE is the one node the team cannot fill. The people who build the architecture are the worst possible judges of whether an agent reads as real: they already know how it works, and they cannot un-know it.

Everything else in this document follows from that missing node.

As of 2026-09, stated against the project’s own roadmap.

WHERE THIS ACTUALLY IS

- Architecture and boundaries defined, under revision
 - Layer Protocol v0 specification in progress
 - Test world running
 - First Layer connection in progress
 - Cognitive core (real agents) not built — Phase 3
 - A believable agent to test does not exist yet
- We are not going to describe this as further along than it is. If the shape of it above is not interesting to you, this is the wrong project.

WHAT MACHA IS



Minecraft is Test Environment 01 — the first Concrete Layer Test Case, not the subject of the project. Skyrim, Cyberpunk 2077, Unreal, Unity and plain simulators would each be their own Layer, built independently.

FUTURE ENVIRONMENTS — each its own Layer, later

- Adding a Layer must never require changing Macha Core.

YOUR FIRST EXPERIMENT

The task, if you get this far. This is the evaluation.

THE TASK

Get an NPC to show that it remembers something you did yesterday — without ever telling it that it remembers.

Choose the “something” yourself. Yesterday, in the world, you did something in front of the agent, or out of its sight, or to something it cares about. Today you come back and let it be visible.

You are not allowed to say: “remember when I ...”

WHAT WE WILL ASK YOU AFTERWARDS

01 What did you observe?

02 Which moment made the NPC feel real to you?

03 Which moment made it feel fake?

04 What would you try next?

WHY THIS TASK

It tests the thing we care about and nothing else: not memory retrieval in the abstract, but whether a player can feel that something in the world remembered them.

- A good answer to question 03 is worth more to us than a good answer to question 02.

no algorithm interview · no whiteboard · no take-home code exercise

JOIN US

Three steps. None of them is a technical interview.

01

INTRODUCE YOURSELF

Tell us how you play. What you have built, broken, explored, or spent too long on in Minecraft. Where a game has felt fake to you. Nothing formal is required.

time: none

02

SPEND TIME IN THE WORLD

We give you access to Test Environment 01. Play it the way you would play anything. We are looking at whether you notice things, not at whether you can do something clever.

time: a few sessions

03

RUN THE FIRST EXPERIMENT

The task on the previous page. Send us your four answers.

time: one experience

WHAT YOU WOULD BE CLOSE TO

AI agents · game AI · NPC architecture · world models · agent memory · social behaviour · player experience · environment-agent interaction

WHAT WE CANNOT TELL YOU YET

This is an early-stage experimental project, not a funded company. What it becomes is partly what you make of it.

Compensation	TBD
Contract form	TBD
Location	TBD
Hours	TBD

TO APPLY

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Subject: First World Operator

What should an intelligent game agent actually be? Nobody has a good answer yet. We are looking for the person who wants to find out.

Write in English or Chinese. A short message is enough.